Georgia PSC AI Ethical Considerations for Educators: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Ethical Considerations in the Appropriate Use of AI for Educators (Georgia Professional Standards Commission, 6/16/25)*. Page numbers match the document's own page numbering. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text.

Implementation (excerpt)

Source: page 3

Effective implementation requires clear reporting lines for misuse of AI, particularly with respect to data privacy breaches and malicious misuse.

Ethical Principle #1 (excerpt)

Source: page 4

Applicable Standards:

- Educators should only use district-approved AI tools.

Ethical Principle #2 (excerpt)

Source: page 5

Educators should not direct students to use AI tools that are age-restricted without verifying district approval and obtaining necessary parental consent where required by federal or state law.

Ethical Principle #3: Protecting Personally Identifiable Information

Source: pages 5–6

When using AI, educators, administrators, and staff have a responsibility to proactively protect the personally identifiable information entrusted to them.

Applicable Standards:

- Only district-approved AI applications should be used.
- Promptly and effectively notify appropriate personnel and any affected members of the school community of any unauthorized access or loss of staff and student data, in accordance with local district and educator preparation provider (EPP) policies, guidance, practices, and training.
- [For Administrators] Proactively evaluate the use of staff and student data by third-party software, determining what data are being collected and for what purpose.
- Verify AI tools comply with federal and state laws and regulations, as well as district policies, regarding the handling of student personally identifiable information.
- Implement parental consent procedures when required by federal or state law for the use of AI tools by students under the age of 18, or when student data may be used or generated.
- Avoid AI platforms that lack clear data use, storage, and ownership policies.
- Establish clear and understandable policies, regulations, rules, and other guidance regarding the collection and use of student data by third-party software, and effectively communicate those policies to the school community.

Guiding Questions:

- Is the application or software approved for use by the district?
- Does the AI tool I am using transmit, store, or generate any personally identifiable student information?
- Have I or my students included any personally identifiable data in uploads or prompts?
- Am I adhering to applicable legal requirements regarding student privacy (FERPA, COPPA, HIPAA, etc.) when using AI tools?
- What data is the AI tool collecting, and how is it stored?
- Do we have policies and procedures for responding to breaches of student privacy or misuse of student data?

Ethical Principle #4 (excerpt)

Source: page 6

Building leaders and educators should follow acceptable use policies and agreements to mitigate harm and protect students from potential harm arising from the use of AI while under the school's supervision.

Ethical Principle #6 (excerpt)

Source: page 7

Only approved AI tools should be used.

Principle #7 (excerpt)

Source: page 8

Do I know where to find reliable resources and district-approved guidance to continue learning about AI?

[For educators and administrators] Have I provided adequate guidance to students to use AI ethically and safely?